CISCO SECURE · HMF DESIGN CLINIC · FACILITATOR

Solution Guide

Reference answers & the Good · Better · Best ladder

This is your model-answer companion. For every pain point you'll find the fitting Cisco solution, how a strong SE explains it, the outcome it delivers — and what **Good**, **Better** and **Best** sound like, so you can recognise and coach each level.

The customer. Cedarline Health Group is a regional healthcare payer-provider — roughly 8,000 employees across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business that handles the money. Growth by acquisition (including a second data centre absorbed as-is) and a mid-flight, disorderly move to public cloud have left a fragmented security posture. After a security incident in March, the board asked what would have stopped it — and leadership still cannot answer. Budget and executive attention are approved, but explicitly temporary, and the security team is small.

THE EVALUATION APPROACH

Good · Better · Best — a growth ladder, not a grade

We evaluate qualitatively. There are no points — each answer sits on a ladder, and your job is to recognise where it lands and nudge it upward. Every level is a win worth naming.

🌱 Good

NAMES THE FIT

You put the right Cisco solution on the table and show you understand what the customer is actually worried about.

🔷 Better

EXPLAINS THE HOW

You connect that solution to the concern — how it works and why it answers this specific problem — in language the customer would nod along to.

⭐ Best

SELLS THE OUTCOME

You tie it to Cedarline's real constraints and the business outcome they care about, and you place it inside the bigger Hybrid Mesh Firewall story.

Coach both audiences. A security specialist may leap to **Best** quickly — push them on the customer's specific constraints. A generalist SE who reaches **Good** has genuinely succeeded — celebrate it, then show them the one sentence that would make it **Better**.

1

CASE STUDY 1 · REFERENCE

AI Security

🧭 NEW TO THIS AREA?

AI is now part of the attack surface. Cedarline has to prove to regulators that their AI is safe, vet the AI models and tools they adopt before they go live, and get eyes on AI traffic they currently can't see.

🔐 FOR SECURITY SPECIALISTS

Frame around AI Defense: algorithmic red-teaming for model/app validation, supply-chain scanning of models, repos and MCP servers, AI cloud visibility for asset discovery, and runtime prompt/response guardrails via the AI Defense–Multicloud Defense integration.

PAIN POINT 1

> *Under the EU AI Act, we are classified as a 'Provider' for our internal AI systems. We need to demonstrate robustness and cybersecurity compliance to satisfy Article 15. How does Cisco help us meet these specific requirements?*

Fitting solution	**AI Defense** · AI Model and Application Validation
How a strong SE explains it	Cisco AI Defense is specifically designed to support Provider obligations under the EU AI Act. We utilize algorithmic red teaming technology for AI Model & App Validation, which identifies safety and security vulnerabilities at scale. By documenting these validation results and maintaining continuous runtime protection, you create a defensible, auditable framework.
The outcome it delivers	It automates the technical evidence gathering required for "Conformity Assessments." By mapping AI-specific threats to standardized frameworks (like MITRE ATLAS and OWASP), it provides the documentation and continuous monitoring necessary to prove to regulators that your systems are robust and compliant.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names AI Defense and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Cisco AI Defense is specifically designed to support Provider obligations under the EU AI Act. We utilize algorithmic red teaming technology for AI Model & App Validation, which identifies safety and security vulnerabilities at scale.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — It automates the technical evidence gathering required for "Conformity Assessments." By mapping AI-specific threats to standardized frameworks (like MITRE ATLAS and OWASP), it provides the documentation and continuous monitoring necessary to prove to regulators that your systems are robust and compliant. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 2

> *We are integrating various open-source models and third-party agents into our internal workflows. How can we ensure these assets aren't introducing vulnerabilities into our environment before they even go live?*

Fitting solution	**AI Defense** · Supply Chain Risk Management
How a strong SE explains it	Cisco AI Defense addresses this through proactive Supply Chain Risk Management. We scan your model files, repositories, and MCP servers to identify malicious or unsafe assets. By integrating this into your CI/CD pipeline, we can block compromised AI assets before they are deployed, ensuring that your operational environment remains secure from the start.
The outcome it delivers	It enables "Shift-Left" security by creating an inventory of all AI models and agents. By identifying vulnerabilities before production, it prevents the introduction of malicious code or poisoned data into your ecosystem.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names AI Defense and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Cisco AI Defense addresses this through proactive Supply Chain Risk Management. We scan your model files, repositories, and MCP servers to identify malicious or unsafe assets.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — It enables "Shift-Left" security by creating an inventory of all AI models and agents. By identifying vulnerabilities before production, it prevents the introduction of malicious code or poisoned data into your ecosystem. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 3

> *We know AI is showing up across our cloud environments faster than security can track it. We're worried we have models, agents, datasets, and MCP-connected tools running without visibility or consistent controls.*

Fitting solution	**Cisco AI Defense - AI Cloud Visibility** · Ai Cloud Visibility
How a strong SE explains it	That's exactly the visibility gap Cisco AI Defense is built to solve. With AI Cloud Visibility, Cisco AI Defense continuously discovers AI assets across distributed cloud environments, including models, agents, datasets, MCP servers, and agent-to-tool workflows. Instead of relying on teams to manually identify what exists, you get a centralized view of your AI attack surface so you can find unsanctioned assets, assess whether they are protected, and bring them under policy.
The outcome it delivers	dentifies rogue or unsanctioned AI assets Maps relationships across data, models, agents, and tools Gives security teams a single-pane-of-glass view of AI exposure Helps close gaps before unknown AI usage becomes a production risk

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Cisco AI Defense - AI Cloud Visibility and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's exactly the visibility gap Cisco AI Defense is built to solve. With AI Cloud Visibility, Cisco AI Defense continuously discovers AI assets across distributed cloud environments, including models, agents, datasets, MCP servers, and agent-to-tool workflows.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — dentifies rogue or unsanctioned AI assets Maps relationships across data, models, agents, and tools Gives security teams a single-pane-of-glass view of AI exposure Helps close gaps before unknown AI usage becomes a production risk. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 4

> *We're running AI workloads in cloud accounts, but we don't have a reliable way to see which models and AI assets are actually in use. We're also concerned about workloads reaching out to third-party AI models without security knowing about it. And even when we do know the traffic path, we need a practical way to inspect and enforce guardrails on prompt and response traffic in the cloud without changing every application.*

Fitting solution	**AI Defense = AI visibility and guardrail integration Multicloud Defense = cloud account connection, traffic visibility, policy attachment, and egress enforcement** · AI Runtime Protection
How a strong SE explains it	That's exactly what the AI Defense-Multicloud Defense integration is designed to address. Cisco AI Defense uses the integration to discover AI assets in your cloud environments and identify external AI destinations your workloads are calling. Then Cisco Multicloud Defense provides the cloud account connectivity, traffic visibility, and egress gateway enforcement point where AI Guardrails Profiles can be applied. In practice, that means you get AI asset visibility plus runtime inspection of prompt and response traffic at the cloud egress layer. AI Defense gives you the AI-specific visibility and guardrail logic, while Multicloud Defense gives you the cloud-network integration and enforcement point.
The outcome it delivers	Finds AI assets in cloud accounts Identifies third-party AI model usage Uses existing cloud-network control points for enforcement Avoids relying only on application-level changes

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names AI Defense and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's exactly what the AI Defense-Multicloud Defense integration is designed to address. Cisco AI Defense uses the integration to discover AI assets in your cloud environments and identify external AI destinations your workloads are calling.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Finds AI assets in cloud accounts Identifies third-party AI model usage Uses existing cloud-network control points for enforcement Avoids relying only on application-level changes. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

2

CASE STUDY 2 · REFERENCE

Cloud Edge

🧭 **NEW TO THIS AREA?**

Cedarline runs applications across several public clouds, each with its own security settings. That inconsistency is risky and painful to audit. They want one place to set policy and prove it.

🔐 **FOR SECURITY SPECIALISTS**

Unified control plane via Multicloud Defense inside HMF; macro/micro-segmentation to contain east-west movement; consolidated logging mapped to frameworks like NIS2/DORA; Secure Workload + Secure Firewall for hybrid policy consistency.

PAIN POINT 1

> *If a breach occurs in one of our public cloud instances, we are terrified that the attacker will move laterally into our core on-premises systems. How can we contain these threats in a multicloud environment?*

Fitting solution	**Multicloud Defense** · Multicloud Defense Gateways
How a strong SE explains it	Multicloud Defense leverages macro and micro-segmentation capabilities to enforce strict communication boundaries. By integrating with our Hybrid Mesh Firewall and Hypershield, we can isolate workloads and inspect traffic between cloud segments, effectively stopping lateral movement before it reaches your sensitive data.
The outcome it delivers	It provides granular visibility and control over east-west traffic. By applying Zero Trust principles across the hybrid fabric, you transform your network into a series of secure, isolated zones that prevent an attacker from pivoting through your infrastructure.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Multicloud Defense and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Multicloud Defense leverages macro and micro-segmentation capabilities to enforce strict communication boundaries. By integrating with our Hybrid Mesh Firewall and Hypershield, we can isolate workloads and inspect traffic between cloud segments, effectively stopping lateral movement before it reaches your sensitive data.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — It provides granular visibility and control over east-west traffic. By applying Zero Trust principles across the hybrid fabric, you transform your network into a series of secure, isolated zones that prevent an attacker from pivoting through your infrastructure. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 2

> *Our auditors require proof that our security controls are applied consistently across all our cloud workloads. Gathering this data from different cloud providers is a manual, time-consuming nightmare.*

Fitting solution	**Multicloud Defense** · Multicloud Defense Visibility
How a strong SE explains it	Cisco Multicloud Defense provides unified logging and traceability. Because our security framework is integrated across the network fabric, you can generate consolidated reports that map directly to your compliance requirements (such as NIS2 or DORA) across all cloud environments from a single dashboard.
The outcome it delivers	It automates the collection of evidence for security audits. By consolidating logs and policy enforcement data, you create a "single source of truth" that simplifies compliance reporting and demonstrates proactive governance to regulators.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Multicloud Defense and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Cisco Multicloud Defense provides unified logging and traceability. Because our security framework is integrated across the network fabric, you can generate consolidated reports that map directly to your compliance requirements (such as NIS2 or DORA) across all cloud environments from a single dashboard.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — It automates the collection of evidence for security audits. By consolidating logs and policy enforcement data, you create a "single source of truth" that simplifies compliance reporting and demonstrates proactive governance to regulators. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 3

> *We have workloads spread across AWS, Azure, and on-premises data centers. Managing security policies individually in each cloud environment is creating massive operational overhead and leading to inconsistent security posture.*

Fitting solution	**Multicloud Defense** · Unified Security across public clouds
How a strong SE explains it	Cisco Multicloud Defense, integrated within our Hybrid Mesh Firewall architecture, provides a unified control plane. You can define security policies once via Security Cloud Control and enforce them consistently across your entire distributed environment, regardless of the underlying cloud provider.
The outcome it delivers	It replaces siloed, manual configuration with centralized orchestration. By abstracting the security policy from the cloud-native tools, it ensures that your security posture is uniform and eliminates the "configuration drift" that occurs when managing multiple cloud consoles.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Multicloud Defense and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Cisco Multicloud Defense, integrated within our Hybrid Mesh Firewall architecture, provides a unified control plane. You can define security policies once via Security Cloud Control and enforce them consistently across your entire distributed environment, regardless of the underlying cloud provider.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — It replaces siloed, manual configuration with centralized orchestration. By abstracting the security policy from the cloud-native tools, it ensures that your security posture is uniform and eliminates the "configuration drift" that occurs when managing multiple cloud consoles. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 4

> *We have workloads on-prem, in cloud, and in mixed environments, and policy consistency is becoming difficult. Every environment feels different, and we're worried about drift.*

Fitting solution	**Cisco Secure Workload Cisco Secure Firewall Cisco Secure Firewall Management Center (FMC) Cisco Security Cloud Control** · Secure Workload Integration with Secure Firewall Management Center
How a strong SE explains it	That's a common hybrid environment challenge. Cisco Secure Workload helps create a more unified segmentation model by using application dependency awareness and AI/ML-driven policy discovery to define policy based on how workloads actually communicate. Cisco Secure Firewall then enforces broader segmentation boundaries at the network layer.
The outcome it delivers	Reduces policy drift across hybrid and multicloud environments Aligns policy to application behavior, not just static IP-based rules Supports consistent macro and micro controls together

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Cisco Secure Workload Cisco Secure Firewal… and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's a common hybrid environment challenge. Cisco Secure Workload helps create a more unified segmentation model by using application dependency awareness and AI/ML-driven policy discovery to define policy based on how workloads actually communicate.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Reduces policy drift across hybrid and multicloud environments Aligns policy to application behavior, not just static IP-based rules Supports consistent macro and micro controls together. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

3

CASE STUDY 3 · REFERENCE

DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

🧭 **NEW TO THIS AREA?**

Their data-centre perimeter is a patchwork of vendors and an inherited rulebase. Most traffic is encrypted, so they're blind to a lot of it — and when something bad happens, the response is too slow.

🔐 **FOR SECURITY SPECIALISTS**

ISE with pxGrid/ANC for rapid, automated quarantine; Encrypted Visibility Engine (EVE) for threat inference without decryption; Snort ML for unknown/zero-day exploits; Security Cloud Control / FMC for policy consolidation and cleanup.

PAIN POINT 1

> *When our security tools detect a compromised device, our manual response time is too slow. By the time we identify the user and manually isolate the port, the attacker has already moved through the network.*

Fitting solution	**ISE** · Security Group Tags (pxGrid integration)
How a strong SE explains it	Cisco ISE integrates with your security ecosystem via pxGrid and Adaptive Network Control (ANC). When a threat is detected, ISE can automatically trigger a quarantine policy, isolating the compromised device in real-time without requiring manual intervention.
The outcome it delivers	It automates the "Response" phase of the incident lifecycle. By bridging the gap between detection and enforcement, it stops threats at the speed of the network.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names ISE and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Cisco ISE integrates with your security ecosystem via pxGrid and Adaptive Network Control (ANC). When a threat is detected, ISE can automatically trigger a quarantine policy, isolating the compromised device in real-time without requiring manual intervention.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — It automates the "Response" phase of the incident lifecycle. By bridging the gap between detection and enforcement, it stops threats at the speed of the network. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 2

> *Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually.*

Fitting solution	**Cisco Security Cloud Control, FMC, FTD** · Unified Policy Administration
How a strong SE explains it	Cisco applies AI-driven analysis to firewall telemetry and policy data to surface optimization opportunities, reduce manual troubleshooting, and guide cleaner policy administration.
The outcome it delivers	Reduces manual policy review; identifies redundant/stale rules; lowers risk from human error.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Cisco Security Cloud Control and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Cisco applies AI-driven analysis to firewall telemetry and policy data to surface optimization opportunities, reduce manual troubleshooting, and guide cleaner policy administration.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Reduces manual policy review; identifies redundant/stale rules; lowers risk from human error. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 3

> *Most of our traffic is encrypted, so we've lost visibility into a huge part of our environment.*

Fitting solution	**Cisco Secure Firewall (FTD), FMC, Security Cloud Control** · EVE
How a strong SE explains it	Encrypted Visibility Engine (EVE) uses AI/ML-based fingerprinting to analyze encrypted traffic patterns and identify suspicious behavior without decrypting the payload.
The outcome it delivers	Restores visibility into encrypted blind spots; avoids the performance/privacy overhead of decrypt-everything strategies.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Cisco Secure Firewall (FTD) and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: Encrypted Visibility Engine (EVE) uses AI/ML-based fingerprinting to analyze encrypted traffic patterns and identify suspicious behavior without decrypting the payload.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Restores visibility into encrypted blind spots; avoids the performance/privacy overhead of decrypt-everything strategies. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 4

> *We're worried traditional signature-based detection won't catch new or unknown attacks quickly enough.*

Fitting solution	**Cisco Secure Firewall (FTD), FMC, Security Cloud Control** · Snort ML
How a strong SE explains it	That's exactly where Snort ML helps. It adds machine-learning-based detection inside the Snort 3 engine to identify exploit behavior associated with unknown/zero-day threats.
The outcome it delivers	Addresses the gap between known and unknown threat detection; reduces dependence on signature timing.

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Cisco Secure Firewall (FTD) and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's exactly where Snort ML helps. It adds machine-learning-based detection inside the Snort 3 engine to identify exploit behavior associated with unknown/zero-day threats.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Addresses the gap between known and unknown threat detection; reduces dependence on signature timing. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

4

CASE STUDY 4 · REFERENCE

Macro & Micro Segmentation

🧭 NEW TO THIS AREA?

The data centre is 'flat' — once an attacker is inside, they can roam. The Kubernetes estate is fragmented too. Cedarline needs segmentation they can actually adopt without breaking applications.

🔐 FOR SECURITY SPECIALISTS

Cilium (eBPF) for Kubernetes networking and policy; Tetragon for eBPF runtime security and detection; Cisco Secure Workload for application-dependency mapping so micro-segmentation is designed from real traffic before it is enforced.

PAIN POINT 1

> *Network policy helps, but we also need to know what's happening at runtime inside the workload. We need better detection of suspicious behavior and policy violations.*

Fitting solution	**Isovalent** · Tetragon Runtime Security
How a strong SE explains it	That's where Tetragon comes in. Tetragon extends the value of Cilium by providing eBPF-based runtime security and threat detection. It monitors system-level activity and network behavior in real time, so you can detect suspicious actions, investigate runtime events, and enforce security policy closer to the workload. In other words, Cilium helps control connectivity and segmentation, while Tetragon helps you understand and secure runtime behavior.
The outcome it delivers	Adds runtime visibility beyond basic network controls Detects suspicious system and network behavior in real time Strengthens Kubernetes security with deeper workload-level insight

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Isovalent and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's where Tetragon comes in. Tetragon extends the value of Cilium by providing eBPF-based runtime security and threat detection.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Adds runtime visibility beyond basic network controls Detects suspicious system and network behavior in real time Strengthens Kubernetes security with deeper workload-level insight. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 2

> *Our Kubernetes networking feels fragmented across clusters and environments. We're dealing with too many moving parts, inconsistent policies, and too much operational complexity.*

Fitting solution	— · Cilium Networking Policies
How a strong SE explains it	That's exactly where Isovalent Cilium helps. Cilium provides a modern, eBPF-based Kubernetes networking layer that gives you consistent connectivity, policy enforcement, and visibility across clusters and environments. Instead of relying on older, IP-centric approaches that struggle in dynamic Kubernetes environments, Cilium enables more scalable and identity-aware networking designed for cloud-native workloads.
The outcome it delivers	Replaces brittle, IP-centric networking models with a Kubernetes-native approach Improves consistency across dynamic cluster environments Reduces operational complexity with a more unified networking and policy layer

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names the fitting Cisco solution and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's exactly where Isovalent Cilium helps. Cilium provides a modern, eBPF-based Kubernetes networking layer that gives you consistent connectivity, policy enforcement, and visibility across clusters and environments.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Replaces brittle, IP-centric networking models with a Kubernetes-native approach Improves consistency across dynamic cluster environments Reduces operational complexity with a more unified networking and policy layer. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 3

> *Right now we're stitching together separate tools for networking, security, and observability in Kubernetes, and it's creating too much overhead.*

Fitting solution	**cilium and tetragon**
How a strong SE explains it	That's exactly the consolidation opportunity Isovalent addresses. With Cilium for networking and policy, and Tetragon for runtime security, you get a more unified platform for connectivity, segmentation, observability, and security. This helps reduce tool sprawl and gives platform and security teams a more integrated operating model.
The outcome it delivers	Consolidates multiple functions into one platform approach Reduces tool sprawl and operational friction Improves context sharing between networking, security, and operations teams

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names cilium and tetragon and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's exactly the consolidation opportunity Isovalent addresses. With Cilium for networking and policy, and Tetragon for runtime security, you get a more unified platform for connectivity, segmentation, observability, and security.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Consolidates multiple functions into one platform approach Reduces tool sprawl and operational friction Improves context sharing between networking, security, and operations teams. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

PAIN POINT 4

> *We know we need microsegmentation, but we don't have enough visibility into east-west flows or application dependencies to create policy safely. We don't want to break the application.*

Fitting solution	**Cisco Secure Workload Cisco Secure Firewall** · Application dependency mapping
How a strong SE explains it	That's one of the biggest reasons customers adopt Cisco Secure Workload. It gives you deep visibility into workload communication and application dependency mapping, so you can see how applications actually behave before enforcing policy. That visibility helps you build segmentation policy with much more confidence, reduce guesswork, and move toward microsegmentation in a controlled way.
The outcome it delivers	Reveals actual application communication paths Reduces the risk of segmentation causing outages Enables more precise policy design and staged enforcement

🌱 **Good** NAMES THE FIT	Names Cisco Secure Workload Cisco Secure Firewall and clearly gets the concern — the right tool is on the table.
🔷 **Better** EXPLAINS HOW	Explains how it addresses the concern: That's one of the biggest reasons customers adopt Cisco Secure Workload. It gives you deep visibility into workload communication and application dependency mapping, so you can see how applications actually behave before enforcing policy.
⭐ **Best** SELLS OUTCOME	Ties it to Cedarline's constraints and the outcome — Reveals actual application communication paths Reduces the risk of segmentation causing outages Enables more precise policy design and staged enforcement. — and positions it within the wider Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.